

Visual Design System

v0.1 • Foundation for product UI, diagramming, and brand consistency

Design systems, visually.

Technical clarity. Calm surfaces. One restrained accent.

Design intent

- Professional developer-tool aesthetic: precise, calm, and information-first.
- The architecture canvas is visually dominant; chrome and controls stay quiet.
- Use neutral surfaces and borders for structure; reserve accent color for focus, selection, and primary actions.
- Prefer clarity over decoration. Avoid gradients, excessive shadows, and oversized corner radii.
- Dark mode is a first-class target; light mode should be equally intentional.

01 Design principles

These rules should guide every visual decision before individual component styling.

Principle	Meaning in Architekt
Canvas first	The architecture diagram receives the most space and visual weight.
Quiet chrome	Navigation, sidebars, and utility controls should not compete with the canvas.
Technical, not sterile	Use precise spacing and hierarchy, but retain warmth through typography and subtle accent use.
Consistent states	Hover, focus, selected, disabled, success, warning, and error should follow shared tokens.
Progressive detail	Show more information only when the user selects, opens, or requests it.
Renderer ≠ domain	Node styling and coordinates are presentation concerns, never domain fields by default.

Brand personality

- Precise
- Calm
- Capable
- Modern
- Trustworthy
- Developer-oriented
- Approachable to learners

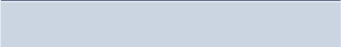
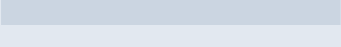
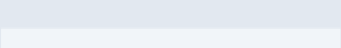
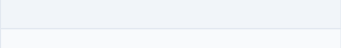
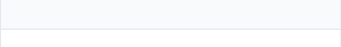
Avoid

- Neon cyberpunk styling
- Overly playful illustrations
- Rainbow infrastructure categories
- Large marketing gradients inside the workspace
- Excessive glassmorphism
- Pill-shaped everything
- Dense enterprise-dashboard chrome

02 Color system

Neutral slate foundations with a single indigo-violet accent. Colors are tokens, not one-off values.

	Ink 950	#0B1220	Primary dark / dark-mode canvas
	Ink 900	#111827	Deep surface

	Slate 800	#1E293B	Strong text / dark border
	Slate 700	#334155	Secondary text
	Slate 500	#64748B	Muted text
	Slate 300	#CBD5E1	Dark-mode border / subtle text
	Slate 200	#E2E8F0	Light border
	Slate 100	#F1F5F9	Light secondary surface
	Slate 50	#F8FAFC	Light canvas
	White	FFFFFF	Primary light surface
	Indigo 600	#4F46E5	Primary accent
	Indigo 500	#6366F1	Hover / active accent
	Indigo 100	#E0E7FF	Accent-soft light
	Indigo 950	#1E1B4B	Accent-soft dark
	Success	#16A34A	Success state
	Warning	#D97706	Warning state
	Danger	#DC2626	Destructive / error state

Semantic application

Token	Light	Dark	Use
bg.canvas	#F8FAFC	#0B1220	Architecture canvas
bg.surface	FFFFFF	#111827	Panels, cards, menus
bg.surfaceSubtle	#F1F5F9	#1E293B	Secondary panels / hover
text.primary	#0B1220	#F8FAFC	Primary text
text.secondary	#475569	#CBD5E1	Supporting text
text.muted	#64748B	#94A3B8	Metadata / hints
border.default	#E2E8F0	#334155	Standard borders
accent.primary	#4F46E5	#6366F1	Primary CTA / selection
focus.ring	#6366F1	#818CF8	Keyboard focus

03 Typography

Inter for product UI. Monospace is reserved for technical identifiers, metrics, and code-like content.

Role	Font	Weight	Size / line-height	Use
Display	Inter Display	700	36 / 42	Landing hero only
H1	Inter	700	28 / 34	Primary page title
H2	Inter	650	20 / 26	Section / panel title
H3	Inter	600	16 / 22	Subsection / card title
Body	Inter	400	14 / 20	Default product copy
Body strong	Inter	600	14 / 20	Emphasis
Small	Inter	400	12 / 16	Metadata / helper text
Label	Inter	600	12 / 16	Form and control labels
Mono	Monospace	500	12 / 18	IDs, protocols, capacity numbers

Typography rules

- Sentence case for UI labels and headings; avoid title case everywhere.
- Use no more than three weights on a typical screen: 400, 600, 700.
- Body copy should usually stay at 14px in the workspace; avoid tiny 10-11px UI text.
- Use monospace selectively; too much monospace makes the interface harder to scan.
- Keep technical labels concise. Prefer “API service” over decorative microcopy.

04 Spacing & layout rhythm

Base unit: 4px. Most product spacing should land on an 8px rhythm.

Token	Value	Typical use
space-1	4px	Icon/text micro-gap
space-2	8px	Compact control gap
space-3	12px	Field internals / compact groups
space-4	16px	Default component padding
space-5	20px	Dense panel spacing
space-6	24px	Section spacing
space-8	32px	Large panel separation
space-10	40px	Page-level spacing
space-12	48px	Large section rhythm
space-16	64px	Marketing / empty-state spacing

Layout guidance

- Workspace header: 48-56px tall.

- Sidebar: 240-280px desktop target; collapsible later if needed.
- Inspector: 280-320px when visible.
- Primary canvas should use all remaining width and height.
- Do not wrap the canvas in a centered marketing-style max-width container once the real workspace begins.

05 Geometry, borders & elevation

Architekt should feel engineered, not bubbly.

Token	Value	Use
radius-sm	4px	Chips, compact controls
radius-md	6px	Inputs, buttons, diagram nodes
radius-lg	8px	Panels, dropdowns, cards
radius-xl	12px	Dialogs / major floating surfaces
radius-full	9999px	Status dots / avatars only
border-1	1px	Default structural border
focus-ring	2px	Keyboard focus ring

Shadow policy

- Prefer borders over shadows for static structure.
- Use a subtle shadow only for floating layers: menus, popovers, dialogs, dragged nodes.
- No glow effects for standard controls.
- Selected nodes may use accent border + soft outer ring instead of a heavy shadow.

06 Iconography

Use one consistent outline icon family, preferably Lucide, at restrained sizes.

Context	Size	Stroke	Notes
Inline / button	16px	1.75-2px	Default control icon
Toolbar	18px	1.75-2px	Canvas tools
Empty state	24-32px	1.5-1.75px	Keep subtle
Infrastructure node	16-18px	1.75px	Optional category icon

- Do not mix filled and outline icon systems.
- Never rely on icon alone for destructive or ambiguous actions without an accessible label/tooltip.
- Avoid decorative icons when text is clearer.

07 Core controls

Baseline UI building blocks for the workspace.

Component	Height	Radius	Visual rule
Primary button	36px	6px	Accent fill, white text, subtle hover
Secondary button	36px	6px	Surface fill + border
Icon button	32-36px	6px	Transparent or subtle surface
Text input	36px	6px	Surface + 1px border + focus

			ring
Textarea / prompt	Auto, min 72px	8px	Surface + border; generous padding
Select / dropdown trigger	36px	6px	Match input
Chip / status	24px	4px	Subtle background; no oversized pills

State behavior

State	Treatment
Hover	Small surface or accent shift; no dramatic motion
Active / pressed	Slightly darker surface/accent
Focus-visible	2px focus ring using focus.ring; must be keyboard-visible
Selected	Accent border + accent-soft background where appropriate
Disabled	Reduced contrast; preserve legibility; disable pointer affordance
Error	Danger border/text with concise explanation
Success	Success icon/text; avoid full green surfaces unless necessary

08 Diagram visual language

The diagram is Architekt's signature UI. It should feel more precise than generic flowchart software.

Element	Specification
Canvas	Light #F8FAFC / Dark #0B1220
Grid	Subtle dot grid; 16-24px spacing; very low contrast
Default node	160-200px wide; min 48px tall; 6px radius; 1px border
Node surface	Light #FFFFFF / Dark #111827
Node label	14px / 600; primary text color
Node metadata	12px; secondary or monospace where technical
Selected node	2px accent border or 1px border + soft accent ring
Edge	1.5-2px neutral stroke; direction clearly visible
Selected edge	Accent stroke
Arrowhead	Small, clear, consistent; avoid oversized arrows
Handles	Hidden or subtle until hover/connection mode

Initial node anatomy

Zone	Content	Rule
Header	Optional icon + component name	Always the strongest text
Body	Optional category / technology	Do not show until the model supports it
Footer	Optional metrics / status	Future only; avoid speculative UI now

Infrastructure category accents (future)

- Do not assign rainbow colors to every component in v0.1.
- If categories become useful later, prefer a tiny icon/badge/accent strip rather than fully colored cards.
- Color must not be the only signal for category or state.

09 Workspace shell

Recommended structural styling once the static prototype becomes the real editor.

Area	Specification
Top bar	48-56px; surface background; bottom border; compact project context
Left tools	240-280px; surface; right border; scroll independently
Canvas	Flexible; fills remaining viewport; minimal padding
Inspector	280-320px; optional/contextual; left border
AI command area	Bottom command bar or collapsible panel; should not dominate canvas
Floating canvas controls	Compact 32-36px icon buttons on a bordered surface

10 Responsive & accessibility

Desktop editing is the primary experience; accessibility is a foundation, not polish.

Breakpoint intent	Behavior
Desktop $\geq 1024\text{px}$	Full editor chrome; canvas + optional sidebar/inspector
Tablet $768\text{--}1023\text{px}$	Collapse secondary panels; preserve canvas and primary tools
Mobile $< 768\text{px}$	Prioritize viewing, pan/zoom, and inspection; full editing can be deferred

- Target WCAG AA contrast for text and interactive states.
- Every interactive icon needs an accessible name; tooltips do not replace labels for screen readers.
- Use visible focus states and preserve keyboard navigation order.
- Do not encode selected/error/success state with color alone.
- Touch targets should generally be at least $\sim 40\text{px}$ even when visible icon controls are smaller.
- Respect reduced-motion preferences if transitions are introduced.

11 Motion

Motion should communicate state, never become visual decoration.

Token	Duration	Use
motion-fast	100-150ms	Hover / pressed / focus transitions
motion-base	150-200ms	Menus, small panels
motion-slow	200-250ms	Large panel reveal only when useful

- Prefer opacity, transform, and subtle color transitions.
- No gratuitous canvas animations.
- Avoid animating layout when it harms spatial orientation.

12 Implementation tokens

Suggested starting tokens for Tailwind/CSS variables. Names are more important than the exact implementation syntax.

```
--color-canvas: #F8FAFC;  
--color-surface: #FFFFFF;  
--color-surface-subtle: #F1F5F9;  
--color-text: #0B1220;  
--color-text-secondary: #475569;  
--color-border: #E2E8F0;  
--color-accent: #4F46E5;  
--color-accent-hover: #6366F1;  
--radius-sm: 4px;  
--radius-md: 6px;  
--radius-lg: 8px;
```

```
--space-unit: 4px;
```

Dark mode overrides

```
--color-canvas: #0B1220;  
--color-surface: #111827;  
--color-surface-subtle: #1E293B;  
--color-text: #F8FAFC;  
--color-text-secondary: #CBD5E1;  
--color-border: #334155;  
--color-accent: #6366F1;
```

13 Design QA checklist

Use this before considering a new screen or component visually complete.

- ☐ Does the canvas remain the strongest visual element?
- ☐ Are all spacing values on the defined 4/8px rhythm unless there is a reason not to be?
- ☐ Is the component using an approved radius instead of a one-off value?
- ☐ Are borders doing the structural work before shadows are introduced?
- ☐ Is accent color reserved for primary action, focus, selection, or meaningful state?
- ☐ Does the component work in both light and dark mode?
- ☐ Are hover, focus-visible, selected, disabled, and error states defined where relevant?
- ☐ Are interactive controls keyboard accessible and clearly named?
- ☐ Is any React Flow-specific visual data kept outside the domain model?
- ☐ Is the UI showing only behavior that actually exists?

Versioning guidance

- v0.1 is intentionally small. Add tokens only when real product components create a repeated need.
- Do not freeze diagram node styling until interactive editing is tested.
- Document changes that alter the visual language; do not create a new token for every one-off exception.
- The design system should evolve alongside the product, not ahead of it.